

TEXT OF REMARKS BY

**PROFESSOR AHMED TIJJANI MORA, B.Sc (Pharmacy), MBA, PhD, FPCPharm,
FPSN, FICEN, FIHMN, FNIM, OON, mni**

(K'ayayen Sarkin Musulmi, Wakilin Maganin Zazzau, Iyan Piriga)

**PRO-CHANCELLOR AND CHAIRMAN OF THE GOVERNING COUCL OF IGBINEDION
UNIVERSITY OKADA (IUO), OKADA EDO STATE.**

**PRESENTED AT THE 2024/2025 OATH-TAKING AND INDUCTION CEREMONY FOR
FRESH GRADUATES OF THE FACULTY OF PHARMACEUTICAL SCIENCES, AHMADU
BELLO UNIVERSITY (ABU), ZARIA**

**AS SPECIAL GUEST OF HONOUR
ABDULLAHI MAHADI (1000-SEATER) CONFERENCE CENTRE, ABU MAIN CAMPUS,
SAMARU, ZARIA
THURSDAY, 12TH FEBRUARY, 2026**

PROTOCOL

It is indeed a great pleasure for me to be here today as the Special Guest of Honour in this beautiful facility, the Abdullahi Mahadi (1000-Seater) Conference Centre, for this important event of the Pharmacy Council of Nigeria (PCN). I wish to sincerely thank the Vice-Chancellor, Professor Adamu Ahmed, for approving my participation as Special Guest of Honour, undoubtedly upon the recommendation of the Dean of the Faculty of Pharmaceutical Sciences and his team. I am deeply grateful for this honour and do not take it for granted.

To the graduands present here today, this is your special day. I taught you *Pharmacy Management* in your 400 Level year, so we are certainly not meeting for the first time.

I also extend my appreciation to the Vice-Chancellor, the Dean, the Heads of Departments, and the entire Faculty, including the Departments of Pharmaceutics, Pharmaceutical Microbiology (now defunct), and Clinical Pharmacy and Pharmacy Practice. I am profoundly grateful for the opportunity given to me over the past forty (40) years, beginning in 1986 when I approached the then Dean, Professor C.O.N. Wambebe, CON (of blessed memory), and offered to teach Pharmacy Management at the undergraduate level, and later at the M.Sc (Clinical Pharmacy) and PhD levels. I remain thankful for the continued trust and recognition shown to me by successive Deans and Heads of Department.

Since the Keynote Speaker has already delivered a beautiful and well-researched paper, it is not my intention to present another academic discourse. Rather, I wish to counsel and advise the graduands, drawing from my experiences in this

University and in other Faculties of Pharmacy across Nigeria, particularly during my eight (8) years as Registrar and Chief Executive Officer of the Pharmacists Council of Nigeria (PCN), as well as in my earlier and subsequent engagements after leaving that office.

I cannot recall the number of times I stood at the Assembly Hall, the Mamman Tsoho Kontagora Convocation Square, the Pa Ishaku Lecture Theatre, or the Gabriel Osuide Lecture Theatres (GOLT I & II) to induct or address fresh graduates, whether as Registrar of PCN, Chairman of ABUPAA, or as Dean of the Faculty of Pharmaceutical Sciences, Kaduna State University. However, today's ceremony is unique. It is the first time I am participating in this capacity at this new venue and in my current role as Pro-Chancellor and Chairman of the Governing Council of Igbinedion University, Okada (IUO), Edo State, the first private university in Nigeria, established in 1999.

The Guest Speaker spoke eloquently on the topic: *"Stepping into the Future: Pharmacy Practice and Innovation in the Digital Age."* This reminds me of an event on 24th November 2007 at the Assembly Hall of this University, where I served as Chairman at the public presentation of a book titled *"Pharmacy Education and Information Technology in the 21st Century,"* authored by an undergraduate student of this Faculty, Kabiru Abubakar Gulma. It was the first time an undergraduate student in our Faculty published and publicly presented a book.

If you compare the title of that book with today's keynote topic, you will observe a common theme: Pharmacy has embraced digital transformation for many years. As graduates of ABU Zaria and as pharmacists, you must be well grounded in Information Technology and position yourselves as key players in this digital era.

Kabiru Gulma went on to earn his Master's and Doctor of Philosophy (PhD) degrees. On Saturday, 31st January 2026, he called to inform me that he had been promoted to the rank of Full Professor, effective 20th January 2026.

I share this story deliberately to emphasize that learning does not end with your first degree. There are numerous areas in which you can further develop your skills, expertise, and competencies, not only within the core Pharmaceutical Sciences, but also in Public Health (MPH), Computer Science, Management, and other related fields.

Pharmacy practice in today's global arena requires practitioners who are versatile and technologically proficient, capable of engaging in computer-aided design of pharmaceutical products, interpreting prescriptions efficiently, identifying drug interactions promptly, and advising co-healthcare professionals appropriately.

Additionally, the business dimension of pharmacy practice, including international business, is an area in which pharmacists must be knowledgeable. Multinational pharmaceutical companies seek pharmacists with a global outlook and a strong understanding of the corporate dynamics of the global pharmaceutical industry.

Finally, I congratulate the Dean, the academic, technical, and administrative staff of the Faculty for successfully inducting the 106 graduands who will soon commence their internship.

I equally congratulate the students and their parents or guardians, and I wish you all a fulfilling and impactful future in the practice of Pharmacy.

Thank you for your kind attention.